

Five minutes to a traceable literature review.

One workbook, six connected sheets: Search Log → Screening → Deep Read → Synthesis Matrix, with a dashboard that counts everything. Start in the tool you already use.

Microsoft Excel (recommended)

1. Unzip nothing — just double-click `Literature-Review-Tracker.xlsx`.
2. If Excel shows a yellow "Protected View" bar, click **Enable Editing** (the file comes from a download, that's all).
3. Read the **Start Here** tab (60 seconds), then log your first search in **Search Log**.

Google Sheets

1. Go to `sheets.google.com` and open a blank spreadsheet.
2. Menu **File** → **Import** → **Upload**, choose `Literature-Review-Tracker.xlsx`.
3. Pick **"Replace spreadsheet"** and confirm. Formulas, dropdowns and colors survive the trip.
4. Rename the file (e.g. "Literature Review Tracker") — done.

LibreOffice & Apple Numbers

LibreOffice Calc opens the file out of the box. Apple Numbers works too — minor visual differences (colors, column widths) are possible. For the smoothest experience we recommend Excel or Google Sheets.

Three habits that make it work

- ① Log the search *before* you screen — exact string, hit count, export count.
- ② One row per record in **Screening**, decision + reason — and copy the Author (Year) cell into **Deep Read**, don't retype it: the auto-check matches the exact text.
- ③ Matrix on Fridays: ten minutes marking Core / Supports / Contradicts / Mentions.

Good to know

- The **Dashboard** computes itself — never type there (it's protected against accidents; you can unprotect it anytime). It also tracks the numbers you need for a PRISMA 2020 flow diagram.
- The **AI Prompts** sheet: copy a prompt, fill the [brackets], paste into ChatGPT, Claude or any assistant. The judgment stays yours.
- Duplicate the file per review. Archive, don't delete — your Search Log is the audit trail reviewers ask about.
- **Something broken or confusing?** Message us on Etsy (or kontakt@arbeitstyp.de) — we answer within 48 hours.